Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Manager
Consor Canada, Toronto, ON

Re: Environmental GIS Analyst

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Environmental GIS Analyst position in Toronto. Since January 2024 I have been an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, where much of my work is building and looking after spatial data. Before that I was a Transportation Planner at Metrolinx, and my master's research at the University of Alberta used GIS to assess wildfire evacuation plans.

At the City I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets the division depends on, using GIS and Python, including a right-of-way width dataset covering all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript. I also built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought three Transportation Tomorrow Survey years into one validated source people now report from. I work in ArcGIS Pro, QGIS and SQL daily, and use Python to automate the repetitive parts. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. My GIS work has been in transportation planning, not environmental consulting, and I have not mapped natural heritage, habitat, archaeology, hydrology or hydrogeology, or worked with the regulatory approval processes behind them. I have not processed LiDAR, drone or satellite imagery, run field data collection workflows, or built web maps and story maps in ArcGIS Online. My GIS experience is about four years rather than five, and I do not hold a GIS certification. I am applying because the core of the role, building clean spatial data and turning it into maps and analysis that others can use, is what I do now, and I would like to learn the environmental side from a team that works in it.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

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